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The GPL is one of the most liberal, and compact rules in the computer world today. It is clear that the GPL is meant not for profit making, but for enabling wide distribution of software products that adhere to the agreement.

Some of the provisions of GPL are, however, under debate—especially the right to modify and distribute a program (with the source code) without being obligated to inform or acknowledge the original writer. While some people say that true open source means the right to modify and spread, others say this leads to confusion and can take the credit away from the original writer. But the basic philosophy seems to be “liberal is better than proprietary.”